

Letter of Recommendation

July 25, 2026

To the Admissions Committee,

My name is Bilal Özden, and I am a lecturer at Thomas More University of Applied Sciences, where I taught Aryan Shah in Data Science, Machine Learning and Forecasting, and Artificial Intelligence. I am pleased to recommend him for the Master of Science in Applied Informatics: Artificial Intelligence at Vrije Universiteit Brussel.

During his studies, Aryan consistently demonstrated an analytical mindset and a particular interest in machine learning and artificial intelligence. He attended classes actively, participated in discussions, and regularly asked questions that went beyond the basic concepts, seeking to understand the assumptions, limitations, and possible improvements of different methods.

A clear example was Aryan's strong performance in my Machine Learning and Forecasting examination. For a real-world cycling-demand problem, he systematically compared several forecasting models, incorporated seasonality, holidays, and weather data, and used cross-validation and baseline comparisons to justify his final selection. Rather than merely applying an algorithm, he analysed why each addition affected performance and correctly identified weather as a key predictive factor. This demonstrated his analytical judgement, methodological discipline, and ability to apply machine-learning concepts to practical problems.

Aryan's self-discipline, analytical ability, intellectual curiosity, and solid foundation make him well suited to VUB's advanced coursework, particularly Statistical Foundations of Machine Learning, Reinforcement Learning, Current Trends in Artificial Intelligence, and the master's thesis. I believe this programme is an excellent opportunity for him to deepen his data science and AI expertise.

I confidently recommend Aryan for admission. Please feel free to contact me should you require any additional information.

Best regards,

Bilal Özden

Lecturer, Machine Learning & Forecasting

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